

Bazaar



We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

Bose MediaMate

The audiophile's desktop companion

The MediaMate speakers are designed to address all the needs of today's multimedia user. They provide a rich, deep-bass performance, in addition to their superb sound.

The speakers are endowed with a spaciousness-enhancing circuitry that produces a good pseudo-surround effect. Special proprietary circuitry provides unbelievable bass at low listening levels. The only sore point was the lack of an On and Off switch, and a power indicator.



These speaker sets are expensive—for the same price you can buy a 6.1 speaker set for an immersive sound experience. The MediaMate are targeted at the brand-conscious audience who don't mind paying the extra bucks for the Bose name.

SPECIFICATIONS

Full range stereo speakers, two RCA inputs, stereo headphone jack, 8.9 x 21.6 x 19.1 cm

Price: Rs 9,800
Contact: Bose Corporation India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-28324537/ 79
Fax: 022-28324579
E-mail: bose_store@sify.com
Web site: www.bose.com

Bose MediaMate		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Apple iPod 30GB

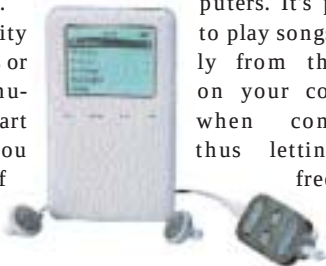
The apple of your ears

With a storage capacity of a whopping 30 GB, this baby confirms to the 'fill it, shut it, forget it' funda. The 25-minute skip protection ensures that it can be the perfect jogging companion.

The iPod's capacity translates into 500 hours or about 3 weeks of continuous playback. A 'Smart Playlist' feature allows you to rate songs on a scale of 1 to 5. Higher rated songs play more fre-

quently when the shuffle mode is on.

You can also use the device as a portable hard drive to transfer any kind of data between different computers. It's possible to play songs directly from the iPod on your computer when connected, thus letting you free up precious



space on your hard drive. Starting from the interface, computer connectivity and transferring the music, the iPod is a breeze to use. The provided earbud-style earphones produce crystal clear music. If you are an audiophile and can't think of leaving home without music,

the Apple iPod is the portable digital music player to own.

SPECIFICATIONS

30 GB capacity, 2-inch greyscale LCD with LED backlight, Audio support for Mac and Windows, 4.1 x 2.4 x 0.73 inches, 176 gms, FireWire interface, USB adapter sold separately

Price: Rs 32,000 for 30 GB, Rs 26,000 for 15 GB, Rs 21,000 for 10 GB
Contact: Telecompac Infosys
Phone: 011-26688171
Fax: 011-26685817
E-mail: bally@del3.vsnl.net.in
Web site: www.apple.com

Apple iPod 30GB		A-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Seagate Barracuda ST380023AS

Goodbye PATA, hello SATA

The ST380023AS is one of the first SATA drives to enter our markets. It supports a maximum theoretical speed of 150 Mbps, but the HDtach test pegged the score at 55.6 Mbps, with an alarmingly high CPU utilisation of 21 per cent.

It doesn't offer any real performance benefits; the only significant feature is the mammoth 8 MB cache—all the performance gains are only due to the extra cache. This isn't because of the SATA interface, but because hard disk technology isn't advanced enough.

This drive costs 40 per

cent more than Seagate's 80 GB Parallel ATA drive. Although rooted to be the future of storage technology, the performance of the Barracuda is not up to theoretical expectations, and the price is too high.

SPECIFICATIONS

80 GB, 7200 rpm, 8 MB internal cache, internal transfer rate up to 570 Mbps, external transfer rate up to 150 Mbps, sustained transfer rate of 27 to 44 MBps, average latency 4.16 ms, average access time 9.4 ms

Price: Rs 10,000
Contact: eSys Distribution Pvt Ltd
Phone: 011-26420450
Fax: 022-23879020
E-mail: naresh@esysmail.com
Web site: www.seagate.com

Seagate Barracuda ST380023AS		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	